

Digilians

SKILLS MODULE

Career Planning

CAREER PLANNING

Participant's Manual



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Module 1: Introduction to Career Planning

What is career planning?

- A career is a long-term professional journey undertaken for a significant period of a person's life with opportunities for progress.
- It is the path you follow to fulfill your professional goals and ambitions.
- Career planning is the process one goes through to decide and pursue their desired career path.
- This is based on some aspects that include personal traits, interests, values and market awareness.

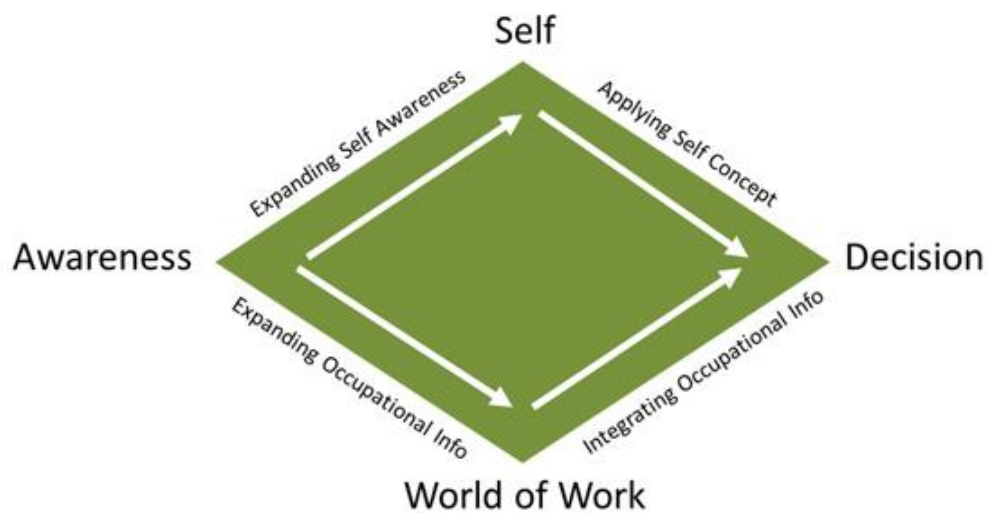
Career planning is a process for:

- Identifying what you are good at
- Knowing how your skills, talents, values, and interests translate into possible jobs or careers
- Matching your skills to existing jobs or careers
- Matching your career goals to your financial needs

Module 2: Career Planning Model

The Career Diamond

- The Career Diamond places the **Self** on top of the diagram, representing the person in charge of managing career issues.
- The **World of Work** is placed along the bottom representing the external factors influencing career choices.



Understanding the 'Self': Self-awareness

- Interests
- Values
- Personality

Values:

- What is most important in your life?
- What are your priorities in life?
- Where do you find meaning?

Prioritize Career Values:

What's the most important value to me?

- Salary
- Job Stability
- Free Time
- Making an Impact
- Location
- Company Culture
- Work Environment
- Family and Personal Life
- Competition

How to Identify your Career Values?

1. Reflect on your past career experiences
2. Analyze your experiences
3. Define your personal values
4. Rank your values by importance

World of Work

- Freelancing career
- Entrepreneurship
- Full time job

Benefits of Freelancing

- More freedom & flexible hours
- Self-management
- Location flexibility
- Exposure to global brands
- Expanding professional networks
- Compensation and earnings control
- Ability to test a startup or small business concept

Benefits of Entrepreneurship

1. Autonomy and Flexibility
2. Personal and Professional Growth
3. Pursuit of Passions
4. Potential for Financial Success
5. Ability to Innovate
6. Networking and Community

What are Emerging trends?

- Emerging trends are patterns, behaviors, or preferences that are gaining popularity or influence in a specific industry, niche, or audience.
- They can be driven by various factors, such as technology, culture, social media, events, or customer feedback.
- A study by Upwork, a freelancing platform, revealed that 59% of mid-sized companies plan to use more remote freelancers in the upcoming months, and 60% plan to do so in the next two years.
- Freelancers report a surge in demand for their services, indicating a growing preference for flexible, project-based work arrangements.
- This aligns with the concept of the gig economy, where temporary or freelance jobs are increasingly common.
- A 2017 study cited by Synchrony Bank states that 71% of freelance workers reported finding work online in increasing amounts.

What are Market Demands?

- Based on the mentioned market trends and freelancer observations, here are some skills you might consider improving to meet the evolving requirements of the labor market:



Adaptability & Continuous Learning:

The rise of the gig economy and increased demand for specialized skills necessitate adaptability and a willingness to continuously learn new skills.

Digital Proficiency

Technological advancements are crucial for freelance success and increasingly important across various industries.

Effective Self-Management & Time Management

With the increasing demand for flexibility and work-life balance, self-management and time management skills become even more critical.

Communication & Interpersonal Skills

Building strong relationships and effectively communicating your value proposition are essential for freelancers to secure and retain clients.

Business and Entrepreneurship

As a freelancer, you essentially run your own business, requiring an understanding of business fundamentals.

Emerging Markets

Navigating change in emerging markets, characterized by their rapid growth and development, requires a unique approach.

Stay Informed

Keeping yourself updated on emerging trends and market movements is critical for making informed decisions.

Navigating change in emerging markets, characterized by their rapid growth and development, requires a unique approach.

Develop Market-Specific Expertise

Understanding the specific nuances of your target emerging market is crucial for successful adaptation.

Navigating change in emerging markets, characterized by their rapid growth and development, requires a unique approach.

Embrace Flexibility and Agility

Be prepared to adapt your strategies and approaches as the market landscape evolves and unexpected challenges emerge.

Navigating change in emerging markets, characterized by their rapid growth and development, requires a unique approach.

Prioritize Cultural Sensitivity

Building trust and respect with local stakeholders requires an understanding of the cultural context and sensitivity to local customs.

Navigating change in emerging markets, characterized by their rapid growth and development, requires a unique approach.

Invest in Building Relationships

Strong relationships with local partners, stakeholders, and consumers can provide valuable support and insights in navigating the complexities of the market.

Module 3: Career Action Plan

SMART Goals

S: SPECIFIC	What do you want to accomplish?
M: MEASURABLE	How do you plan to track your progress?
A: ACHIEVABLE	Is this goal achievable and realistic?
R: RELEVANT	How relevant is this goal to you?
T: TIME-BOUND	How long will it take to achieve this goal?

Create Your Career Action Plan

1. Career interests
2. Goals
3. Actions
4. Resources
5. Expected challenges
6. Solutions

Resilience for Freelancers

- It is the ability to bounce back from challenges and maintain well-being despite the uncertainties of self-employment.
- It's about developing a mental toughness that allows you to face setbacks, maintain a positive outlook, and emerge stronger.

How to Keep Resilient?

1. Find a coach.
2. Consider your career options.
3. Don't give up.
4. Stay positive.
5. Be grateful.

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